

Spotlight.



Snitch City • Part 2

For a troubled force, a chief with his own past

BY DUGAN ARNETT | GLOBE STAFF

ILLUSTRATION BY J.D. PAULSEN FOR THE GLOBE

For years, Paul Oliveira was the unrivaled star among New Bedford detectives, leaving scores of drug busts — and unanswered questions

New Bedford Mayor Jon Mitchell gathered civic leaders and reporters for a major announcement one afternoon in June 2021.

A decade into his tenure, Mitchell, a former federal prosecutor who once led the task force that tracked down the fugitive gangster Whitey Bulger, had chosen the city's next police chief, the man who would lead one of the state's largest police departments.

His pick?
Paul Oliveira.
“This is an auspicious occasion, because I've known this individual for a long time, and I'm fully confident that he is up to this job,” Mitchell told the crowd.

The two had worked cases together years earlier, when Mitchell was a young prosecutor in the US attorney's office in Boston and Oliveira was climbing the ranks of New Bedford's Police Department.

Oliveira stood beside the mayor that afternoon, stoic. Like the rest of the nation, New Bedford was grappling with the racial reckoning in law enforcement that followed the George Floyd murder. But the city was on an upswing and crime statistics were down significantly.

“Policing has changed dramatically throughout the careers of those of us standing here,” Oliveira, then 51, said. “I believe that those experiences — good and bad — will now fuel us forward through the next chapter of police reform.”

Nearly a quarter-century had passed since Oliveira rose to local prominence, orchestrating what was then the largest drug bust in city history. Since, his hair had thinned, his tanned features softened. But he still looked like he could lead a team of detectives through a drug-house door.

“If somebody would have told me 20 years ago that I'd be police chief,” it would've been “crazy,” he said in an interview not long after his appointment. “But, you know, that's life, right?”

Oliveira wasn't the only one who seemed surprised by his promotion. Others who had worked alongside him, served him as informants, or been arrested by him were confounded.

They sent texts or chatted, but only among one another: *This guy? Does the FBI know? But what about ...*

Despite their shock — and in some instances, anger — they kept their concerns buried. No one spoke out in that moment or the years since — at least not publicly.

SNITCH CITY, Page A13

KITTY DUKAKIS 1936-2025

An advocate for others who bravely battled personal tests

Promoted women, confronted addiction

By Joseph P. Kahn
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

During the 1988 presidential campaign, Kitty Dukakis gave countless speeches and interviews on behalf of her husband, Massachusetts Governor Michael S. Dukakis, the Democratic nominee, striking back forcefully at his Republican opponents while transforming herself into the very model of the modern political spouse.

As the state's first lady, she championed a wide range of causes, including aid to the homeless and advocating on behalf of political refugees.

It was as a private citizen, though, that Mrs. Dukakis made her most indelible mark, writing and speaking candidly — often painfully so — about her struggles with alcoholism and depression,



Kitty Dukakis in 2009

►Massachusetts political leaders remember former first lady. B2.

the treatment options she'd sought, and the relapses she had suffered.

“Obviously, the story isn't over. I am still struggling to resume my place — with one important difference,” she wrote in “Now You Know,” her 1990 memoir, in a passage

DUKAKIS, Page A24

Kennedy political legacy, family ties tested by Trumpism

By Emma Platoff and Sam Brodey
GLOBE STAFF

Of the 11 children Robert and Ethel Kennedy brought into the world, Kerry and Bobby Jr. had their own close bond.

Bobby's late second wife, Mary Richardson Kennedy, was Kerry's best friend. They raised their children a mile apart and had dinner every Wednesday, spending weekends and vacations together, too. So many years ago, when it was clear that their beliefs had begun to sharply diverge, Kerry went to her brother with a proposal.

“Let's find ways of talking about and thinking about what we have in common, and please, don't talk to me about vaccines,” she recalled telling him. “You and I are never going to agree on it, and it just causes strife in our relationship.”

Until recently, it was possible to maintain that distance, Kerry said in an interview. But her brother's run for president meant his beliefs about vaccines, which scientists warn are incorrect and

KENNEDYS, Page A8

The Globe and Statista rank the 50 fastest-growing companies in the region. **Globe Magazine.**

We've got a few suggestions on what to watch on TV this spring, from a new Jon Hamm dramedy to a show about a murderous robot. **N1.**

Breeze frame

Sunday: Sunny, cooler.
High: 41-46. Low: 31-36.
Sunrise: 6:42 Sunset: 7:00
Complete report, **B10.**

VOL. 307, NO. 82

Suggested retail price
\$6.00



BOSTON WILL CROWN THEIR
NEWEST CHAMPIONS THIS WEEK
TICKETS STILL AVAILABLE AT [TICKETMASTER.COM](https://www.ticketmaster.com)



Official Local Partners



Official Local Broadcast Partner

